VESTA STATION COOPERATIVE
OFFICE OF COOPERATIVE REGULATION // PUBLIC SAFETY DIVISION

VSC-RN-04-23
ISSUED: MARCH 2113
AF DATE: 9 AF
STATUS: ACTIVE
CODE REF: §04 ART.23

◆ REGULATORY NOTICE — PUBLIC SAFETY

FIREARMS CARRIAGE AND DISCHARGE ORDINANCE

Carriage Conditions, Weapon Lock Requirements, Fees, Prohibited Items, and Enforcement Powers Applicable to All Persons Entering or Present Within Vesta Station Jurisdiction

APPLIES TO: **ALL PERSONS — NO EXCEPTIONS BY STATUS, AFFILIATION, OR LICENCE OF ORIGIN**

IN FORCE: 15 MARCH 2113

◆ 1. AUTHORITY AND PURPOSE

This Notice is issued under Vesta Station Cooperative Law, **Section 04, Article 23**, by the Office of Cooperative Regulation acting with the full authority of the Cooperative Council. It governs the carriage, storage, and discharge of all weapons capable of projecting a physical round, flechette, bolt, or beam within Vesta Station's pressurised jurisdiction, including all docking ring sections, commercial zones, hab blocks, service corridors, and exterior-facing structural areas.

This Notice was prompted by a pattern of incidents in 2111–2112 in which ballistic discharge in composite-hull zones caused or nearly caused structural breach. It should be read in conjunction with **VSE-TB-0291** (Hull Material Integrity Ratings), which provides the engineering basis for the weapon-lock requirements set out in Section 3 below.

◆ 2. CARRIAGE CONDITIONS BY WEAPON CLASS

WEAPON CLASS	STATUS	CONDITIONS
Holdout pistol	UNRESTRICTED	No permit required. No registration. Concealed or open carry both permitted. No fee.
Knives and bladed weapons (non-monofilament)	UNRESTRICTED	No permit required. Standard commercial carriage assumed.
Shock weapons and stunners	UNRESTRICTED	Unrestricted. Recommended for commercial zone carry

		where hull-safe discharge is a priority.
Medium pistol — concealed	UNRESTRICTED	No permit required. No registration. Concealed carry.
Medium pistol — open carry	FEE	Same-day kiosk registration required. Fee: **10 cr**. Registration valid for duration of station visit. Kiosks at all docking ring entry points.
Long arms (rifles, shotguns, long-frame railguns)	PERMIT	24-hour advance permit required from Public Safety Division. **Fee: 40 cr.** Must be declared at docking entry. Conspicuous carry only — no concealment permitted for long arms.
Semi-automatic (SA) capable weapons	LOCK REQUIRED	Must be station-locked to single-shot mode before entry or immediately upon arrival. See Section 3. **Fee: 30 cr per weapon.** Unlocked SA weapon in composite zone is treated as an active breach threat.
Burst-group (BG) capable weapons	LOCK REQUIRED	Must be station-locked to single-shot mode. See Section 3. **Fee: 30 cr per weapon.** BG discharge in any composite or exterior zone is treated as reckless endangerment regardless of intent.
Flechette-pattern weapons (shredder class)	LOCK REQUIRED	Station-lock to single-shot mandatory. **Fee: 30 cr.** Discharge near any viewport assembly classified as automatic breach event under VSE-TB-0291. Single-shot lock does not remove hull-breach risk — discharge in composite zones requires extreme care regardless of mode.
Monofilament weapons	PERMIT	Restricted permit required. **Fee: 80 cr.** Not available for general commercial applicants. Security contractor licence required.
Hull-breach capable weapons (seeker rounds, explosives, shaped-charge systems, area-denial munitions)	PROHIBITED	No permit available. Confiscation on detection. Criminal referral automatic. Station security authorised to use lethal response against active deployment.
Monofilament weapons	PERMIT	Restricted permit. **Fee: 80 cr.** Security contractor licence required. Not available for general commercial applicants.

◈ 3. STATION-LOCK REQUIREMENT — SA AND BG WEAPONS

Any weapon capable of semi-automatic or burst-group discharge must be physically locked to single-shot mode before the weapon enters Vesta Station's pressurised jurisdiction. The lock is a hardware modification applied to the weapon's fire-control mechanism by a licensed armourer and is reversible on departure.

> ◈ WHY THIS REQUIREMENT EXISTS
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> The station-lock requirement is not punitive. It reflects an engineering reality established in **VSE-TB-0291**: in high-stress situations, a burst-group or flechette weapon discharged in a composite-hull zone will cause structural breach regardless of the operator's intentions. The spread pattern of a standard flechette discharge at combat range exceeds the face area of a standard viewport panel. **Intent is not a mitigating factor when the outcome is decompression.**

LOCK SERVICE PROVIDERS	SERVICE FEE
Any licensed armourer on Vesta Station. Kiosk directory available at all docking entry points. Current licensed providers: 14 stations across Docking Ring and Coppervein Market zones.	**30 cr per weapon. Fee covers lock application and departure reversal. No additional charge for reversal at departure if original armourer receipt is presented.**
LOCK DURATION	CONTRACTOR EXEMPTION
Valid for duration of station visit. Lock is logged to docking registry entry record. Reversal on departure is not a regulatory requirement but is the armourer's standard practice.	**Licensed security contractors operating under a Vesta Station cooperative security contract may apply for single-shot exemption. Application fee: 200 cr. Review period: 72 hrs. No retroactive exemptions.**

◈ 4. PROHIBITED ZONES — DISCHARGE

Discharge of any ballistic weapon — regardless of carriage status or lock mode — is prohibited in all areas where composite or transparisteel materials form part of the pressure boundary. This includes all exterior-facing corridor sections, docking ring outer-face modules, prefabricated hab modules, and any area within 10 metres of a transparisteel viewport assembly.

◈ DISCHARGE IS PROHIBITED IN THE FOLLOWING ZONES WITHOUT EXCEPTION

- All exterior hull corridors and docking strut access passages (0.0g sections)
- Docking ring commercial zone outer-face sections (Levels 3–5, all arcs)
- All prefabricated module sections including short-stay accommodation units
- Within 10 metres of any transparisteel viewport assembly, including hotel and hab-block windows
- All docking bay interiors while docking collars are extended

Discharge in regolith-carved sections (tunnel corridors, sub-surface hab blocks, carved service passages) is not prohibited under this Notice, but remains subject to all other applicable provisions of Cooperative Law including Section 12 (Assault) and Section 44 (Reckless Endangerment).

◈ 5. PENALTIES AND ENFORCEMENT

Unlocked SA/BG weapon in composite zone — first offence	`200 cr fine` + immediate confiscation pending lock application
Unlocked SA/BG weapon in composite zone — repeat offence	`500 cr fine` + 48hr detention + weapon confiscation
Discharge causing hull breach or attempted breach	`Criminal referral` — Section 44, Reckless Endangerment. Minimum 90-day detention pending trial.
Prohibited weapon in station jurisdiction	`Immediate confiscation` + criminal referral + station ban
Discharge in prohibited zone (no breach caused)	`300 cr fine` + weapon confiscation for duration of visit
Carriage without registration where registration required	`50 cr fine` + immediate registration required

Enforcement authority: Vesta Station Cooperative Security (VSCS) officers are authorised to inspect weapons for lock compliance on request, to confiscate non-compliant weapons, and to detain individuals discharging weapons in prohibited zones. VSCS is *locally employed and accountable to the Cooperative Council* — not to inner-system corporate security frameworks. Off-station security licences and corporate security credentials do not confer exemption from this Notice.

◈ 6. ENFORCEMENT POSTURE — SELECTIVE APPLICATION

The Cooperative Council acknowledges that enforcement of this Notice is applied with discretion by VSCS officers in practice. Long-term residents and established commercial operators with clean records are unlikely to face inspection without cause. Newly arrived visitors, particularly those presenting with inner-system corporate affiliations, should expect closer scrutiny. This is not policy — it is practice. Visitors are advised to achieve full compliance regardless of perceived enforcement likelihood.

DIRECTOR OF PUBLIC SAFETY
OFFICE OF COOPERATIVE REGULATION
VESTA STATION COOPERATIVE

COOPERATIVE COUNCIL RATIFICATION
SECTION 04 ARTICLE 23 AUTHORITY
MAJORITY VOTE: 11/14 IN FAVOUR

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MANDATORY POSTING AT ALL DOCKING ENTRY POINTS — COOPERATIVE LAW §04.23.8